A clearer view of grassroots basketball.

The Westview Group

HOOP THINK

For parents. Useful to everyone around the game.



The Big Read

A headline is not a recruiting plan

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“Are we behind?”

By Keil Moore
The Westview Group

The game. The decisions. The people in between.

The Starting Point

Everybody has a plan for your player. Who is explaining it?

An invitation arrives. Then another.

A showcase wants your registration. A trainer recommends a package. A club has an opportunity. Someone says a college coach is interested.

> **Each message asks for something: money, time, travel, trust.**

The harder question is what your player gets back.

That's where Hoop Think starts. Not with the assumption that every opportunity is a bad one—or that every family needs to become an expert in college athletics. We want to help you ask better questions, understand what you're being told, and make decisions that fit the player in front of you.

Parents are our starting point. Coaches, directors, trainers, scouts, and event operators belong in the conversation, too. If you help shape a young player's experience, this is for you.

Here's what's worth thinking about this week.

Keil Moore
The Westview Group

This week

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The game. The decisions. The people in between.

A practical editorial guide for families navigating grassroots basketball—with useful context for the coaches, trainers, scouts, program directors, and operators who shape the experience.



The Big Read

A headline is not a recruiting plan

College basketball's rules deserve attention. But a proposal, an adopted rule, and a rule that applies to your child are three different things. Before your family changes course because of a headline, get answers to three questions:

1 What has actually changed?

2 When does it take effect?

3 Does it apply to this player, at this level, in this situation?

Then bring the conversation back to the decision you are making.

Are you choosing a club? Evaluating a college? Considering a paid opportunity? Those decisions may raise different questions. Don't let one sweeping explanation stand in for answers specific to your family.

For the people advising players: explain what you know, identify what remains uncertain, and make it clear when a family needs an answer from a school, governing body, or qualified adviser.

"I don't know yet" is a useful answer when it comes with a plan to find out.

What are you buying this weekend?

A tournament, a showcase, and a development camp should not have to make the same promise. The problem is when the promise is unclear.

Before paying, ask the organizer:

- [ ] Is this primarily instruction, competition, evaluation, or exposure?
- [ ] What does the schedule actually include?
- [ ] How are teams or groups formed?
- [ ] Who is coaching or evaluating?
- [ ] If college-coach attendance is advertised, what is confirmed?
- [ ] What happens if the format changes?

Then ask your player a different question:

"What would make this weekend worthwhile for you?"

The answer might be competing against stronger players. It might be getting comfortable in a new role. It might be receiving specific feedback.

Name the purpose before deciding whether the event fits it.

For operators

For operators, this is an opportunity, not an accusation. **Tell families exactly what you deliver. Let the value stand on its own.**



Read past the commitment graphic

A commitment announcement tells us where a player is going.

It doesn't tell us everything about how the decision came together—or whether the same choice would make sense for someone else.

Our recruiting coverage will report the news, then look underneath it:

- What basketball fit is the player choosing?
- What has the coaching staff said about the role?
- What does the roster look like?
- What remains unknown?

For parents, the useful lesson is not

~~"How do we get that offer?"~~

It's

"What would we need to understand before choosing that situation?"

A ranking can be part of the conversation. It should not have to carry the whole conversation.

One Thing to Do

Put the recruiting conversation in one place



This week, create a shared recruiting notebook. Keep it simple enough that you will actually use it:

Record	What to include	Notes
School contact	Name, role, date, and what was discussed	
Offer	Exactly what was communicated and any written terms	
Visit	Dates, arrangements, expenses, and unanswered questions	
Next step	Who is responsible and when to follow up	
Player's reaction	What your child liked, disliked, or still wants to understand	

Keep the last row.

An organized process should make room for the player's voice, not bury it under everyone else's opinions.

A useful follow-up message:

"Thanks for speaking with us. Here is our understanding of the conversation and the next steps. Please correct anything we missed."

What happened before the catch?

For one stretch of the next game, put the scoring total aside.

Watch what your player does before receiving the ball.

Do they look at the defense?

Notice a teammate cutting?

Recognize open space?

Or does the decision-making begin only after the catch?

Try watching five catches. Make a short note about what happened before and after each one.

	Before the catch	After the catch
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

Afterward, lead with curiosity:

"What were you seeing on that possession?"

Not every possession needs to become a lesson. This is simply another way to talk about the game beyond makes, misses, and minutes.

Coaches and trainers can join that conversation by explaining what they want players to recognize—not just which move they want them to execute.

Around the Gym

Three questions worth carrying

For a club coach

"What are you trying to help this player improve, and how will we recognize progress?"

For a trainer

"Where should this skill show up in a game?"

For a college program

"How do you communicate with a player whose role is smaller than expected?"

None of these needs to be a confrontation. They are invitations to explain the work.

The Parent Question

"Everyone else seems to be committing. Are we behind?"

Before answering that, define "behind."

Behind another player's announcement?

Behind a school's actual deadline?

Or behind the timeline your family hoped for?

Those are different situations.

Write down what is real: current conversations, available opportunities, stated deadlines, unanswered questions, and what your player wants.

Then ask the people involved to clarify the next step.

Someone else's announcement is news. It is not, by itself, an instruction for your family.

You don’t need to know everything about grassroots basketball.

You do deserve clear explanations from the people asking for your money, your time, and your trust.

That’s the standard we’ll bring here, too.



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